

Φιλίκος ὁ Κερκυραῖος

Philicus of Corcyra, Hymn to Demeter and Persephone

eul_aid: ick

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή λογοτεχνική [Literary Koine](#)
Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Philicus of Corcyra was a Hellenistic poet of the 3rd century BCE. He served as a priest of Dionysus and was associated with the court of Ptolemy II Philadelphus in Alexandria, where he was a member of the Pleiad, a group of seven tragic poets.

Only one of his works survives: a fragmentary Hymn to Demeter composed in choliamb, preserved on a papyrus. Although credited with composing tragedies as part of the Pleiad, none of these dramas are extant. His significance stems from his position within the Alexandrian literary milieu, illustrating the integration of religious office, royal patronage, and poetic production.

The surviving hymn is notable for its use of choliamb—a meter typically used for satire—in a hymnic context. This exemplifies Hellenistic metrical experimentation and provides a rare example of non-hexameter cult poetry from the period.

Works (1)

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